

Metrics Based Process Mapping for Automation Discovery

Map the work.
Measure the pain.
Automate with
purpose.

A practical working session for identifying the right automation opportunities —
starting with the work, not the tool.



How Today Will Run

We will work through four parts. The aim: leave with a practical way to identify, assess, and prioritise automation opportunities.



Why

Why automation discovery needs evidence



What

What Metrics Based Process Mapping gives us



How

How to map, measure, and assess



Apply

How to test the method against real scenarios



Two hours on the calendar — core session is 90 minutes, with space for questions, discussion, and real examples.



SECTION 1

Why

Why automation discovery needs evidence

Before we ask "what can we automate?" — we need to ask "what is actually happening?"

From Assumption-Led to Evidence-Led Automation

Pain is a useful signal. Evidence helps us decide what to do next.

Instead of starting with...

- "This process is painful."
- "This should be automated."
- "This takes too long."
- "We need a workflow, bot, or tool."
- "Everyone knows this is broken."

We want to ask...

- What exactly is happening?
- Is automation the right response?
- Where is the time actually going?
- What problem are we solving?
- What evidence do we have?

Common Automation Traps

We do not want to automate noise. We want to automate where there is clear value.

Starting with the tool

The solution leads the conversation before the problem is understood.

Automating the loudest pain point

The most visible issue gets prioritised, not necessarily the most valuable.

Automating a broken process

The same problems happen faster — not better.

Ignoring exceptions

Automation works only for easy cases; edge cases still need manual handling.

Missing handoffs

One step improves, but the end-to-end process stays slow.

No baseline metrics

Without a starting point, it becomes hard to prove value later.

SECTION 2

What

What Metrics Based Process Mapping gives us

A practical way to understand the work, evidence the pain, and make better automation decisions.



The Core Model

Metrics Based Process Mapping combines three things. The value comes from the combination — not any single element alone.

Process Map

Shows how work flows

Steps, roles, systems, decisions

Metrics

Shows where pain exists

Volume, time, effort, wait, errors, risk

Automation Lens

Shows what is worth automating

Value, feasibility, readiness



Map the
Work

Measure
the Pain

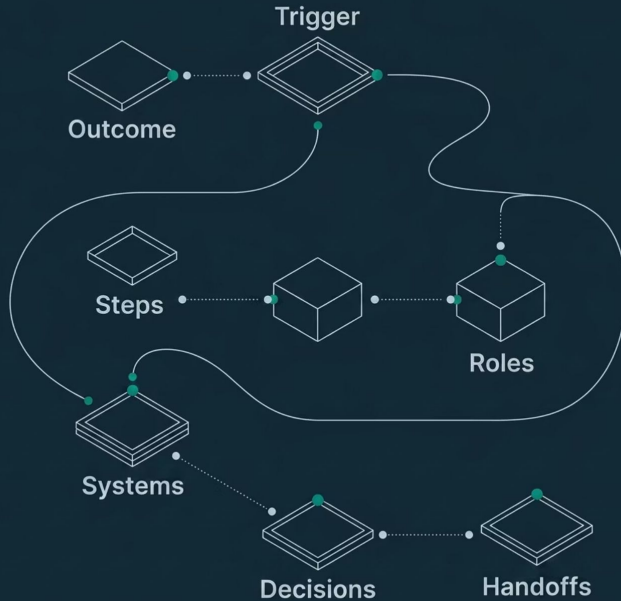
Decide the
Response

Prioritise
Opportunity

This approach draws from recognised practices — process mapping, value stream mapping, process measurement and automation discovery — and applies them in a lightweight, practical way.

Process Mapping Basics

A process map is a shared picture of how work happens. Most people only see their part — mapping helps us see the whole flow.



What a useful map helps us see

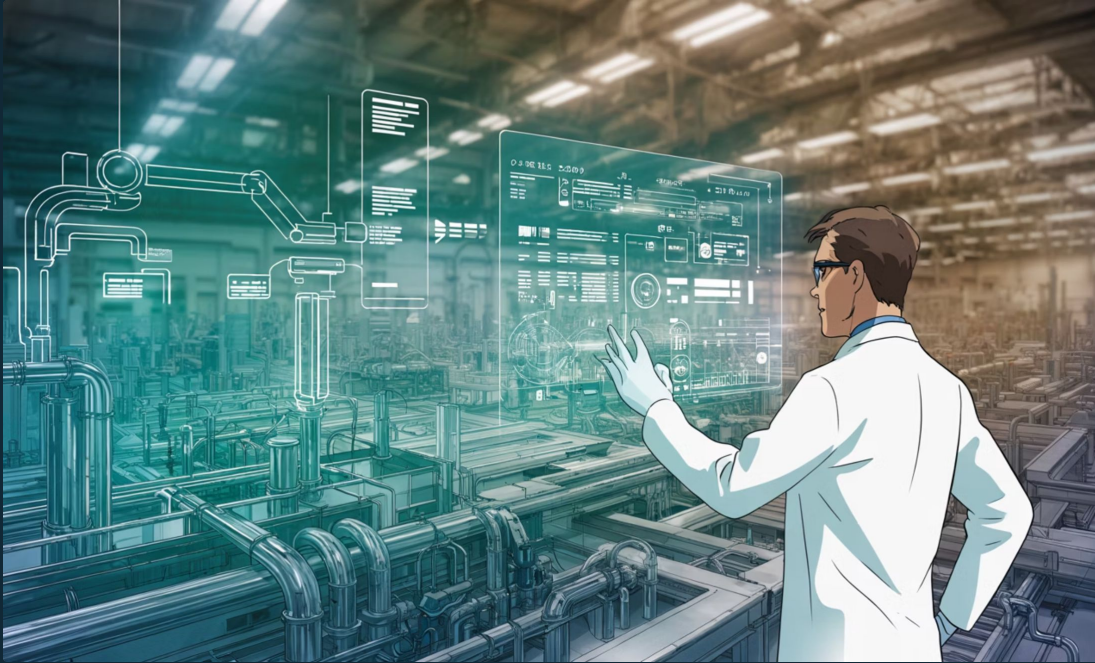
- What starts the process and what outcome is needed
- The main steps, who is involved, and what systems are used
- Where decisions happen and where handoffs occur
- Where exceptions arise



You do not need to become a BPMN expert. The value is in creating a shared picture people can look at and say, "Yes, that is how the work actually happens."

What Makes It Metrics-Based?

A process map shows the flow. **Metrics** show the pain. We add evidence to make the invisible visible.



Evidence we add to the map

- How often the process happens
- How long it takes end to end
- How much human effort is involved
- Where work waits and where errors occur
- How many handoffs and exceptions exist
- What systems are touched and what risk is created

□ We are looking for **enough evidence to make a better decision** — not perfect data before we start. Estimates are fine as long as we are clear they are estimates.



SECTION 3

How

How to map, measure, and assess

We keep it simple: define the process, add the evidence, then decide the right response.

1

Map the work

2

Measure the pain

3

Decide the response

4

Prioritise the opportunity

What to Capture When Mapping

Start with the normal path first — then layer in decisions, handoffs, and exceptions. A useful map beats a perfect one.

Trigger	What starts the process?
Outcome	What needs to be achieved?
Steps	What happens from start to finish?
Roles	Who does each step?
Systems	What tools, forms, or systems are used?
Decisions	Where are choices or approvals made?
Handoffs	Where does work move between people or teams?
Exceptions	What happens when it deviates from the standard path?



Key message: Start simple. A useful map is better than a perfect map.

Metrics That Matter for Automation Discovery

Not every process needs every metric. Choose measures that explain the pain and value.



Effort

- **Volume** — How often it happens
- **Touch time** — Actual human effort
- **Manual effort** — repetitive or low-value work



Flow

- **Cycle time** — Total elapsed time
- **Wait time** — Time spent idle
- **Handoffs** — Movement between teams
- **Systems used** — tools, forms or platforms touched across the process



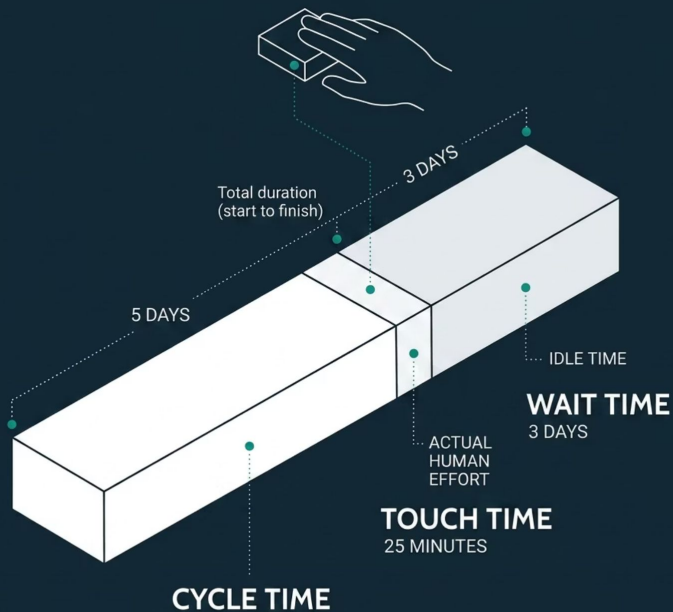
Quality & Risk

- **Rework / errors** — How often work needs fixing
- **Exceptions** — Deviations from standard path
- **Risk impact** — What happens if it goes wrong
- **User impact** — Who feels the pain



Key message: You do not need every metric - just the ones that help the pain and value

Time Is Not One Thing



Why this distinction matters

A process that takes 5 days may involve only 25 minutes of actual work. The rest is waiting. If the issue is wait time, full automation may not be the right answer. Consider:

- Workflow routing and reminders
- Clearer approval thresholds
- Fewer handoffs
- Better intake processes

❏ **Key message:** Slow processes are not always effort-heavy processes.

From Pain Point to Possible Response

Automation is one possible response — not the only one. Match the fix to the real problem.

Pain Point	Possible Response
Missing information	Better form, validation, or guidance
Manual data entry	Integration or data transfer automation
Long approval delay	Workflow routing, reminders, or escalation
Repeated status chasing	Automated notifications or dashboard
Frequent rework	Standardisation, validation, or clearer rules
Inconsistent decisions	Decision tree, policy clarification, or guardrails
Too many exceptions	Process redesign before automation
Poor visibility	Tracking, reporting, or workflow transparency



Key message: The right response may be automation, process improvement, standardisation, clearer rules — or a combination.

Assessing Automation Opportunities

Use three lenses to evaluate each candidate. All three must align for a strong opportunity.

Value

Is this worth solving? Look for time saved, risk reduced, rework reduced, better experience.

Feasibility

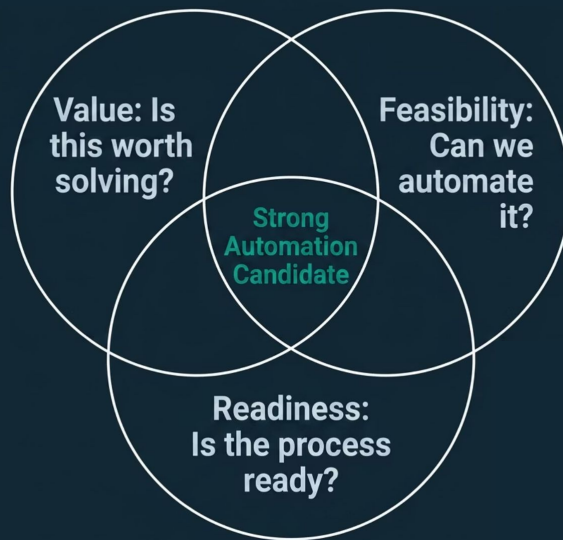
Can we automate it? Look for clear rules, stable data, system access, and a technical pathway.

Readiness

Is the process ready? Look for a process owner, agreed steps, a stable process, and stakeholder support.



Key message: A good automation candidate needs to be valuable, feasible, *and* ready.



Strong vs. Weak Automation Candidates

Strong Candidates Usually Have...

- Regular or high volume
- Repetitive steps
- Clear rules and decision logic
- Stable inputs and outputs
- Significant manual effort
- Measurable errors or rework
- Accessible systems or data
- Clear process owner

Weaker Candidates Often Have...

- Low volume
- High judgment required
- Unclear decision-making
- Poor data quality
- Too many exceptions
- Unstable or evolving process
- Unresolved policy or governance questions
- Unclear ownership



Remember: Not ready for automation does not mean not worth improving.

APPLY

Applying the Method to Real Scenarios

Now we test the approach against actual processes and automation ideas. The goal is not to solve everything in the room — it's to test the quality of the opportunity and agree on the next best action.



Scenario Clinic

Where Does This Land?

Automate Now

High value, feasible, and ready

Improve First

Worth solving, but process needs tidying

Investigate Further

Need more data or a technical assessment

Do Not Automate Yet

Low value, unstable, or unclear

To Find Out, We Ask:

1. What is the process, and where does it start and end?
2. Where is the pain — effort, delay, errors, or something else?
3. What evidence do we have, and what are we missing?
4. Is the right response automation, improvement, or both?



Key message: We are deciding the next best action, not fully solving the process in the room.

Wrap-Up and Next Steps

Today We Covered

- Why automation discovery needs evidence
- How to map the work
- How to add useful metrics
- How to identify pain points
- How to avoid jumping straight to automation
- How to assess value, feasibility, and readiness
- How to categorise opportunities

Suggested Next Steps

1. Choose 2–3 candidate processes to map in more detail
2. Validate the process with people who do the work
3. Gather missing metrics
4. Confirm each scenario's category
5. Build a small, evidence-based automation opportunity backlog

Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.